▼ GLASSHOUSE



WEIGHTY ADVICE

Telugu Desam Party (TDP) scion **Nara Lokesh's** dramatic weight loss has drawn the attention of even the top bosses in New Delhi. When Prime Minister **Narendra Modi,** during his May 10 tour of Hyderabad, dropped in at Andhra Pradesh chief minister N. Chandrababu Naidu's Jubilee Hills residence, the conversation apparently also turned to Lokesh's new, slim avatar. While the PM was all admiration for Lokesh's fitness, he advised him not to lose any more weight. The new TDP working president, though, is reportedly determined to get even more trim. Meanwhile, earlier in the day, Modi had paid a visit to another NDA ally, deputy CM and Jana Sena Party chief **Pawan Kalyan**, who is recuperating after a sinus-related surgery. Sources say Modi had a genial conversation with Kalyan's four children and his wife Anna Lezhneva, even attempting a few words in Russian. The PM, it seems, has not forgotten his allies despite the big win in West Bengal.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ BOOK LAUNCH BANTER

PAGES FROM THE PAST

It was the launch of solicitor general **Tushar Mehta's** two books, *The Bench, the Bar and the Bizarre* and *The Lawful and the Awful*, and Union home minister **Amit Shah** was in an unusually relaxed mood. The BJP No. 2 talked about their three-decade-old friendship and Mehta's love for *shayari* and literature, often shared through morning Whatsapp messages. He also reminisced about the two decades they spent in Ahmedabad, when Mehta was practising in the high court and Shah was Gujarat's home minister from 2002 to 2010. Both of them moved to Delhi in 2014 when Narendra Modi became prime minister. Chief Justice of India Surya Kant was one of the honoured guests, so Shah was careful not to court controversy. But he did promise greater candour soon in his views on the judiciary and the executive.

